

ROM Cost Table

Day 2 handout. A rough-order-of-magnitude cost table for your topology. The goal is not finance modeling — it's catching the 2x cost surprise before it ships.

For each component, capture a **rough monthly cost band** and the driver. We're surfacing relative scale, not pricing exactly — engineering will refine.

Component	Stance	ROM cost / month	Cost driver

Reference bands (illustrative, AWS)

Component	Example stance	ROM band	Driver
Postgres (RDS)	Multi-AZ, db.m5.large	400–700	Instance hours; storage; IOPS
Read replica	Single-AZ	200–350	Instance hours
Kafka (MSK)	3-broker, m5.large	700–1100	Brokers; storage; egress
S3 (audit)	Standard tier	\$50 / TB-month	Storage; PUT/GET requests
ALB	Standard	\$25 + traffic	Hours + LCUs
Outbound bandwidth	Estimated	50–150	\$/GB egress to internet

Two things to remember

- **Don't over-precision.** Numbers tighter than a ROM band are a trap. You're hunting 2x surprises, not modeling finance.

- **Name the egress line.** Outbound bandwidth is the cost that hides. Put it on the table as its own line item even if the number is rough.